Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours **green stands between yellow and blue**. In the rainbow map of the chakras it is **the fourth** and belongs to the **heart chakra**. You can imagine it as a place for **closeness**, **compassion** and your relationship with yourself and with others.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

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Anahata, the heart chakra

The chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The heart chakra is called Anahata (from Sanskrit “unstruck”, like a sound that arises without a strike). It sits in the middle of the chest. The element air, the seed syllable **YAM** and a lotus with twelve petals belong to it. Green is linked with it mainly in today's version, while in some traditional depictions another colour is given, for example vermilion.

Its theme is **love**, **compassion**, **forgiveness** and connection with others. For women this often turns into questions. Can I both give and receive? Do I have room in my heart for myself too?

When the chakra is open. You can give and receive, forgive others and yourself, and you do not have to protect yourself all the time. You feel that your place in close relationships is **safe**.

When the chakra is closed. The tradition describes closing off, coldness, loneliness and trouble trusting. Or the opposite. You give and give and then you have nothing. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that you need more closeness, whether to others or to yourself.

When the heart chakra is said to be closed, what is usually meant is **withdrawal**. It is hard to trust someone, accept kindness or show vulnerability. Such an experience has many possible causes and it is not a chakra test.

How to add green when closeness is missing

- **Wear it**
  A green scarf, jumper or necklace near the chest. Something you can keep close to the body.
- **Put it in your home**
  A houseplant, herbs on the windowsill or a cushion. Something alive that you can care for.
- **Eat it**
  Leafy vegetables, herbs, green tea. Slowly and calmly.
- **Head out into nature**
  A walk in a forest or park and a moment by a tree, without your phone.
- **Paint it**
  Soft green circles in the lower part of the paper, with no goal and no judging.
- **Give yourself a small thing**
  A green pencil, notebook or mug of tea just for pleasure.

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When and how to add green when you give too much of yourself

When you have looked after others for a long time and hardly at all after yourself, you do not need more green care, but **boundaries** and tenderness for yourself.

- **Add red**
  In a small dose, as a scarf or lipstick. It is the colour of boundaries and strength.
- **Add pink**
  Powder pink as the colour of self-care. A blanket, bed linen, a candle.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. A wooden table, natural materials.
- **Add cream**
  A soft and calm base. Linen, cotton, light bedding.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You look after everyone. You cook, shop, listen, remember who likes what. Everyone around you is a little more content, only in you, in the quiet of the evening, nothing stirs. Nothing important is collapsing. It is just that the moment when someone looks after you has slipped out of your days.

This is exactly where green can get its personal meaning. **Care can lead to you too**. You can give and receive at the same time, and also allow yourself to say “not today”.

Next to green other colours can feel fresher. Yellow makes it glow, blue quietens it and brown reminds you of the soil under the leaves. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way of sorting out the themes you are living through. Do you add green because you miss closeness and care for yourself? Or do you put it aside because you have given too much? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

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